

SYED SABAIR HUSSAIN

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Email Security Engineer with 5+ years of information security experience, including 2+ years focused on email security engineering and operations. Hands-on expertise architecting and operating advanced email protections using Proofpoint (TAP, TRAP, policy tuning, quarantine workflows, DLP integration) and Microsoft Defender for Office 365 (EOP, Safe Links, Safe Attachments, advanced threat hunting, KQL). Deep proficiency in Microsoft Purview DLP — designing classification label taxonomies, tuning EDM and regex-based detectors, managing exception governance, and running split tests and drift monitoring at enterprise scale. Proven ability to harden email trust and identity through SPF/DKIM/DMARC design and enforcement, DMARC reporting analysis, display name and VIP impersonation controls, QR code phishing detection, and BEC pattern defense. Experienced building API/SOAR-integrated automation playbooks using PowerShell and Python, defining program metrics (catch rate, FP rate, MTTD/MTTR, DLP signal quality), and translating complex email threat findings into crisp, actionable insights for engineers, business stakeholders, and senior leadership. Strong cross-functional force multiplier across Security Monitoring & Response, IAM, GRC, and Security Architecture.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Email Security Platforms: Proofpoint Email Security, Proofpoint TAP (Targeted Attack Protection), Proofpoint TRAP (Threat Response Auto-Pull), Proofpoint DLP, Microsoft Defender for Office 365, Exchange Online Protection (EOP), Safe Links, Safe Attachments, Advanced Threat Hunting (KQL)

Email DLP & Data Protection: Microsoft Purview DLP, Classification Label Taxonomy Design, Exact Data Match (EDM), Regex Detectors, Exception Governance, Split Testing, Drift Monitoring, Policy Enforcement Rules, Data Exfiltration Prevention

Mail Trust & Identity (Email Authentication): SPF, DKIM, DMARC Design & Enforcement, DMARC Reporting & Analysis, Display Name / VIP Impersonation Controls, External Sender Tagging, QR Code Phishing Detection, BEC Pattern Defense, BIML & Brand Protection, Subdomain Strategy & DNS Hygiene, Third-Party Sender Onboarding, Deliverability & Blocklist Monitoring

Mail Flow & Infrastructure: Exchange Online, Connectors & Transport Rules, Mail Header Analysis, DNS (MX, TXT, CNAME), Mail Flow Troubleshooting, Vanity Domain Lifecycle Management, Quarantine Workflows

Automation & SOAR: PowerShell, Python, API Integrations, SOAR Playbooks, Auto-Pull/Recall Automation, Bulk Purge Workflows, VIP Watchlists, Threat Intel Lookups, ETL Pipelines, SQL, Email Threat Intelligence Enrichment

SIEM & Security Operations: Splunk, IBM QRadar, Alert Triage & Correlation, Phishing Campaign Investigation, Incident Response, Post-Incident Improvement, MTTD/MTTR Metrics, Catch Rate & False Positive Rate Tracking

IAM & Access Controls: Active Directory, Microsoft Entra ID (Azure AD), SAML, SSO, MFA, Least Privilege, Identity Lifecycle Management, CyberArk, BeyondTrust

Frameworks & Compliance: NIST CSF, ISO 27001, CIS Controls, GRC Alignment, Audit Support, MITRE ATT&CK (T1566, T1078, T1110), Zero Trust Principles

Certifications: CEH v12 — EC-Council, SC-900 — Microsoft, CompTIA Security+, SC-200 / SC-400 — Pursuing, CISSP — Pursuing

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Email Security Engineer — Security Operations & Threat Response | Capgemini — Enterprise Security Consulting
Oct 2021 – Dec 2023

- **Engineered and operated advanced email protections** using Proofpoint (TAP, TRAP) and Microsoft Defender for Office 365 (EOP, Safe Links, Safe Attachments) — continuously tuning policies to cut false positives and maximize phishing and malware catch rates across enterprise client environments, and championing secure-by-default email configurations that reduced attack surface without disrupting legitimate mail flow.
- **Administered Proofpoint TAP** for URL and attachment defense — configuring sandbox detonation policies, click-time URL rewriting, and quarantine workflows; leveraged TRAP to automate message recall and bulk purge operations following confirmed phishing events, compressing mean time to contain (MTTC) for high-volume campaigns.
- **Designed and operated Microsoft Purview DLP for Exchange Online** — built and maintained the classification label taxonomy, authored EDM and regex-based detection rules, defined exception governance processes, and ran split tests and drift monitoring to sustain long-term policy effectiveness and prevent data exfiltration at enterprise scale.
- **Hardened email trust and identity** by designing and enforcing SPF, DKIM, and DMARC policies across primary and vanity domains — managing DMARC reporting analysis, implementing display name and VIP impersonation safeguards, applying external sender tagging strategies, detecting QR code phishing patterns, and enforcing BEC controls that reduced impersonation-based threats.
- **Managed vanity domain lifecycle and subdomain strategy** — designing subdomain naming conventions, enforcing DNS ownership and hygiene, onboarding third-party senders with DMARC alignment, monitoring deliverability and blocklist status, and escalating DMARC policy from monitoring to enforcement across all sending domains.

- **Led deep-dive phishing campaign investigations** — performed full mail header analysis, Exchange Online mail flow tracing, and connector-level troubleshooting to reconstruct attack chains, identify bypassed controls, and deliver actionable post-incident improvement recommendations that were operationalized into updated detection policies.
- **Built API/SOAR-integrated automation playbooks** using PowerShell and Python to streamline phishing triage, auto-pull and message recall, bulk purge execution, VIP watchlist enforcement, and threat intelligence lookups — significantly reducing MTTR for high-volume phishing events and enabling the team to scale response without adding headcount.
- **Defined and tracked key email security program metrics** — catch rate, false positive rate, MTTR/MTTD for mail events, and DLP signal quality — producing regular executive dashboards and trend reports that informed security roadmap prioritization and drove data-driven control improvement decisions.
- **Served as a cross-functional force multiplier** — collaborating with Security Monitoring & Response to improve phishing detections, partnering with IAM to execute identity-based access lockdowns following account compromise, aligning with GRC on compliance and audit requirements, and coordinating with Security Architecture and Infrastructure to make control fixes permanent and scalable.
- **Conducted advanced threat hunting** in Microsoft Defender for Office 365 using KQL queries — proactively identifying BEC indicators, credential phishing campaigns, and VIP impersonation attempts before end-user reports triggered reactive response, and translating findings into detection logic improvements.
- **Authored and maintained technical standards, operational playbooks, and quick-win documentation** for email security workflows — mentored junior analysts on secure-by-default email practices, coached peers on Proofpoint and Purview platform capabilities, and championed continuous knowledge-sharing across the security team.
- Explored and began implementing Brand Indicators for Message Identification (BIMI) — evaluating BIMI adoption readiness, assessing VMC requirements, and developing a brand protection roadmap to enhance sender trust signals and reduce impersonation risk for organizational sending domains.

Environment: Proofpoint (TAP, TRAP, DLP), Microsoft Defender for Office 365, Exchange Online Protection, Microsoft Purview DLP, Splunk, QRadar, PowerShell, Python, Active Directory, Microsoft Entra ID, ServiceNow, SOAR

SOC Analyst — Email Threat Detection & Incident Response | Mindtree — 24/7 Security Operations Center *Jun 2018 – Oct 2021*

- Monitored and investigated email-based threats — including phishing campaigns, BEC attempts, credential harvesting, and malicious attachment delivery — using Splunk, QRadar, and email security tooling, performing triage, validation, and escalation of confirmed incidents with documented attack timelines and remediation outcomes.
- **Analyzed email headers, mail flow logs, and DNS authentication records** (SPF/DKIM/DMARC) to investigate suspicious messages, trace delivery paths, identify spoofed sender infrastructure, and determine attacker TTPs — producing post-incident reports that informed detection policy updates and authentication control improvements.
- Supported enforcement and validation of email authentication policies across enterprise domains — identifying SPF/DKIM/DMARC misconfigurations and coordinating DNS remediation with infrastructure teams to close authentication gaps and sustain deliverability for legitimate sending domains.
- **Tuned SIEM correlation rules and email security platform policies** to improve detection of phishing indicators, BEC patterns, and anomalous mail flow behavior — reducing false positive volume and improving analyst signal-to-noise ratios across the SOC environment.
- Collaborated with IAM teams to lock down compromised accounts following confirmed phishing-based credential theft — enforcing MFA resets and session revocations in Active Directory and Entra ID, and documenting containment actions for audit and compliance reporting.
- Generated audit-ready incident reports, authentication activity summaries, and phishing campaign post-mortems for management and compliance audiences — establishing a consistent standard of clear, professional communication during and after email security incidents.

Environment: Splunk, QRadar, Exchange Online, Active Directory, ServiceNow, PowerShell, Python, DNS, IDS/IPS, Windows, Linux

PROJECT EXPERIENCE

Attack Surface & Email Security Data Pipeline

Jan 2025 – Apr 2025

- **Designed and developed a centralized email security telemetry pipeline** integrating data from Proofpoint, Microsoft Defender for Office 365, and SIEM platforms into a unified leadership dashboard — providing real-time visibility into catch rates, false positive rates, DLP signal quality, quarantine accuracy, and phishing campaign trends across the enterprise.
- Built Python and SQL automation workflows to ingest, normalize, and enrich email security event data — enabling rapid identification of high-risk senders, compromised domains, and policy bypass patterns that would otherwise require manual analyst review.
- **Defined and tracked email security KPIs** including catch rate, false positive rate, MTTR/MTTD for mail events, quarantine accuracy, and DLP enforcement effectiveness — delivering regular metrics reports that directly informed roadmap prioritization and control tuning decisions for security leadership.

- **Developed automated playbook logic** for phishing triage and response — including message auto-pull triggers, bulk purge execution workflows, and VIP watchlist alerting — reducing manual response effort and compressing MTTR for confirmed phishing events.
- **Implemented drift monitoring logic for DLP policy rules** — automatically flagging rule degradation and label taxonomy drift over time, generating policy review alerts, and ensuring sustained enforcement effectiveness without requiring manual periodic audits.
- Produced comprehensive technical documentation covering pipeline architecture, KPI definitions, alert thresholds, and remediation playbooks — enabling seamless handover and ongoing operation by security team members without specialized pipeline development knowledge.

Identity Threat Detection & Email Security Research

May 2025 – Aug 2025

- **Developed detection pipelines correlating email security events** (phishing delivery, link clicks, attachment detonation) with identity and authentication system logs — enabling detection of compromised accounts and account takeover attempts with higher confidence and reduced dwell time.
- Analyzed phishing and BEC attack patterns — including display name spoofing, lookalike domain registration, and QR code phishing techniques — and designed detection logic mapped to MITRE ATT&CK (T1566 Phishing, T1078 Valid Accounts, T1110 Brute Force) for implementation in Proofpoint and Microsoft Defender for Office 365.
- **Built SIEM enrichment logic** to automatically append threat intelligence context (sender reputation, domain age, DMARC alignment status) to inbound phishing alerts — improving triage accuracy and enabling faster, better-informed analyst response decisions.
- **Evaluated SPF/DKIM/DMARC enforcement posture** across simulated multi-domain enterprise environments — identifying third-party sender misalignment and subdomain hygiene gaps, and producing remediation playbooks for DNS ownership correction and DMARC policy escalation from monitoring to enforcement.
- Assessed email security control coverage gaps across the phishing kill chain — from initial delivery through link click, credential submission, and post-compromise lateral movement — and delivered a structured set of control improvement recommendations applicable to Proofpoint and Microsoft Defender for Office 365 deployments.
- **Produced a research report** presenting email threat intelligence enrichment findings, detection coverage analysis, and recommended SOAR integration patterns for auto-pull, VIP protection, and threat intel lookup automation — formatted for both engineering teams and executive leadership audiences.

EDUCATION

Master of Science (MS) in Cybersecurity | Wright State University

2024 – 2025 (Expected)

Relevant Coursework: Network Security, Email & Messaging Security, Identity & Access Management, Cloud Security, Data Loss Prevention, IT Governance & Compliance

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Ethical Hacker (CEH) v12 — EC-Council
- Microsoft Security, Compliance, and Identity Fundamentals (SC-900) — Microsoft
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Security Operations Analyst (SC-200)
- Microsoft Information Protection Administrator (SC-400)